questions would be a key determinant of India’s eventual decision to ally or not with America.

While India is likely to become more militarily dependent on America in the event of a two-front war with China, India’s capacity to undertake reciprocal commitments in support of the United States in the event of a China–US conflict is limited. India does have the capacity to contribute to the common effort in the Indian Ocean Region, but its role in the primary theatre of a potential US–China conflict is limited. Further, India’s capacity to undertake diversionary military action along the land border is highly constrained by geographical factors, as well as by a lack of sufficient offensive military capability. Even if the mountain strike corps gets raised with its full complement of weapons and equipment, India’s offensive capability along the China front is likely to remain limited. Given such continuing ambiguities about India and America’s respective willingness and capability to provide military assistance to the other, all that can be envisaged at this juncture is the formation of an entente involving relatively weak military support and commitment.

Conclusion

Cooperation and competition have been important elements in India’s China policy since the late 1940s, but the weight, or balance, between cooperation and competition has shifted. Over the last seven decades, Indian security concerns about China have not only persisted but also expanded from subversion to territorial integrity to geopolitical interests in South Asia and now to the Asian order itself. Under these circumstances, it is highly unlikely that India would either be willing to or have the scope to